

Sunday, 19 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Partly cloudy 23° 15°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 23° 14°	MANCHESTER Overcast 22° 13°	GLASGOW Overcast 23° 12°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Burnham to announce plans for new North Sea oil and gas drilling.

Drilling has become a controversial topic for the Labour party after the 2024 manifesto pledged to not issue new licences.

POLITICS · UK
- 2

Ruthless plotter? Flip-flopper? Dad dancer? Insiders reveal the real Andy Burnham.

Who is the real Andy Burnham? Laura Kuenssberg talks to more than 20 people who know him to work it out

UK · NEWS
- 3

Clacton by-election attracts 34 candidates.

The list of people taking on Nigel Farage contains 20 independents and a number of joke candidates.

POLITICS · UK
- 4

Laos says it can't determine cause of tourist deaths linked to methanol.

Officials say they have no evidence of poisoning over the 2024 deaths because autopsies were not conducted.

UK · NEWS
- 5

Second half of summer to bring chances for rain but heatwave threat persists.

Forecasts suggest the weather could turn more changeable during late July and August but the risk of heatwaves remains.

UK · NEWS

What's coming up

- 1 Gracie Abrams captures pain of early adulthood in new album - but you're left wanting more.**
The singer's third album is full of incisive, witty lyrics that are let down by muted production.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 2 16 World Cup viral moments - from Posh Spice's nonchalance to Haaland's bromance.**
We look at some of the most memorable scenes during the 2026 World Cup that set the internet alight.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 3 'Wham! concerts changed lives in China' - Ridgeley.**
A new documentary shows the impact Wham! had on people during their ground-breaking visit to China.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 4 Signed Hockney print found in a book sells for £41K.**
The print, found in a book donated to a Salvation Army shop, is snapped up by an anonymous bidder.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 5 Oscar-winning actress Brenda Fricker dies at 81.**
She won for her role in 1989 film My Left Foot and had well-loved parts in Home Alone 2 and TV's Casualty.
SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

- 1 The Bronze Final - the unwanted tie or a match with a 'golden layer'?**
Why does the Fifa World Cup Bronze Final still exist?
SPORT · UK
- 2 The harrowing dark side of England's World Cup exit.**
During a major football tournament such as the World Cup, some women and girls are constantly living in fear - because domestic abuse rises when England play, research shows.
SPORT · UK
- 3 False nines or firing forwards - England's potential life after Kane.**
Are England facing the prospect of using a false nine up front once record scorer Harry Kane calls time on his international career?
SPORT · UK
- 4 Messi and Brady in disbelief over 'prophetic' Lamine Yamal photo.**
Argentina's Lionel Messi says it is "crazy" to be facing Spain's Lamine Yamal in a World Cup final after being photographed with him as a baby.
SPORT · UK
- 5 All Blacks leave Irish with familiar sinking feeling.**
After a six-try defeat by New Zealand in Eden Park, Ireland have now lost six games in a row against the All Blacks, France and South Africa.
SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1** **Holiday firms report a 40% spike in 'shoulder season' bookings — September and October sun trips are way up on last year.**
Travellers blame school-holiday flight prices, unreliable summer weather, and 'August feels too crowded these days'. Spain, Greece and Portugal top the wish list.
- 2** **A study suggests we underestimate how much our neighbours would like to be asked for help.**
Researchers say a small favour often builds friendships faster than years of polite nodding over the fence.
- 3** **A survey finds most of us have a drawer, shelf or cupboard we're slightly afraid to open.**
The 'everything drawer' is a near-universal feature of British homes. Inside: takeaway menus, dead batteries and one very important thing we'll never find again.
- 4** **The most-Google'd DIY question in Britain this year: 'how to remove silicone'.**
Tradespeople say it's the rise of botched bathroom resealing jobs during lockdown that's still haunting people. YouTube tutorials on the topic have racked up 60 million views.
- 5** **62% of us have lied about reading a book to look smart in front of someone we fancy.**
Most-faked titles: 1984, Pride and Prejudice and (awkwardly) the Bible. One in five admit to faking a whole dinner-party conversation about a novel they'd only seen the cover of.
- 6** **The average Brit checks their phone 159 times a day — but says it 'doesn't feel like that much'.**
Researchers using passive monitoring apps say we badly underestimate our own usage. Most people guess between 30 and 70 times.
- 7** **The humble flask is having a comeback, with sales up sharply as people try to cut café spending.**
Retailers say the big winner is the 'keeps drinks hot for 12 hours' bottle — though most of us still drink it within the first one.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q 63% of dog owners admit they've done THIS when no-one's around.
ANSWER: HAD A FULL CONVERSATION WITH THE DOG ABOUT THEIR DAY.

Q Asked the most British way to end a phone call, the winner was THIS string of words.
ANSWER: 'RIGHT... OKAY THEN... LOVELY... BYE, BYE, BYE, BYE.'

TALK TOPIC

- **Scientists say a good laugh is as good for your heart as light exercise.**
Who in your life can make you laugh no matter what — and what's the daftest thing that's set you off?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **UK News.** A Yorkshire farmer has won a planning row by getting his prize-winning sheep listed as 'agricultural heritage', preventing a housing development from going ahead next to his field.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A Cornish café has started charging customers extra if they ask for the WiFi password before placing their order, claiming it 'improves table turnover by 40%'.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£50 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£50 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A cloud can weigh more than a million pounds — about the same as 100 elephants. They float because they're spread across miles of sky.
- Honey never spoils. Edible honey has been found in 3,000-year-old Egyptian tombs.
- Octopuses have three hearts and blue blood. Two pump blood through the gills, the third pumps it round the body.
- The Eiffel Tower can grow up to 15cm taller in summer because the iron expands in the heat.
- The dot above a lowercase 'i' or 'j' has a name — it's called a tittle.
- Bananas are technically berries. Strawberries, somehow, are not.
- Wombats produce cube-shaped poo. Scientists worked out it's the elasticity of their intestines.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time — 1/100th of a second. So 'back in a jiffy' is the fastest promise you can make.

On this day

Day 200 of the year, 165 days left in 2026. Today Palace Day; Christian feast day: Aurea of Córdoba; Christian feast day: Bernold, Bishop of Utrecht; Christian feast day: John Plessington. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1946 — Alan Gorrie, Scottish singer-songwriter and musician
- 1989 — James Austin Johnson, American actor and comedian
- 1979 — Luke Young, English footballer
- 1941 — Vikki Carr, American singer and actress
- 1951 — Abel Ferrara, American director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1992 — Jake Nicholson, English footballer
- 1962 — Anthony Edwards, American actor and director
- 1983 — Helen Skelton, English television host and actress

THE DAY TODAY

- 1980 — Opening of the Summer Olympics in Moscow.
- 1997 — The Troubles: The Provisional Irish Republican Army resumes a ceasefire to end their 25-year paramilitary campaign to end British rule in Northern Ireland.
- 1981 — In a private meeting with U.S. President Ronald Reagan, French President François Mitterrand reveals the existence of the Farewell Dossier, a collection of documents showing the Soviet Union had been stealing American technological research and development.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1961 — Tunisia imposes a blockade on the French naval base at Bizerte; the French would capture the entire town four days later.
- 1981 — In a private meeting with U.S. President Ronald Reagan, French President François Mitterrand reveals the existence of the Farewell Dossier, a collection of documents showing the Soviet Union had been stealing American technological research and development.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1947 — Prime Minister of the shadow Burmese government, Bogyoke Aung San and eight others are assassinated.

- 2018 — The Knesset passes the controversial Nationality Bill, which defines the State of Israel as the nation-state of the Jewish people.
- 1969 — Chappaquiddick incident: U.S. Senator Ted Kennedy crashes his car into a tidal pond at Chappaquiddick Island, Massachusetts, killing his passenger Mary Jo Kopechne.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 201 of the year, 164 days left in 2026. Today Birthday of Crown Prince Haakon Magnus (Norway); Christian feast day: Ansegisus; Christian feast day: Apollinaris of Ravenna; Christian feast day: Aurelius of Carthage. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1938 — Natalie Wood, American actress (died 1981)
- 1973 — Omar Epps, American actor
- 1971 — Sandra Oh, Canadian actress
- 1968 — Kool G Rap, American hip-hop artist
- 1985 — John Francis Daley, American actor and screenwriter
- 1975 — Jason Raize, American singer and actor (died 2004)
- 1943 — Bob McNab, English footballer
- 1944 — T. G. Sheppard, American country music singer-songwriter

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1989 — Burma's ruling junta puts opposition leader Aung San Suu Kyi under house arrest.
- 1969 — A cease fire is announced between Honduras and El Salvador, six days after the beginning of the "Football War".
- 2012 — Syrian civil war: The People's Protection Units (YPG) capture the cities of Amuda and Efrîn without resistance.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1976 — The American Viking 1 lander successfully lands on Mars.
- 1969 — A cease fire is announced between Honduras and El Salvador, six days after the beginning of the "Football War".

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026	
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)